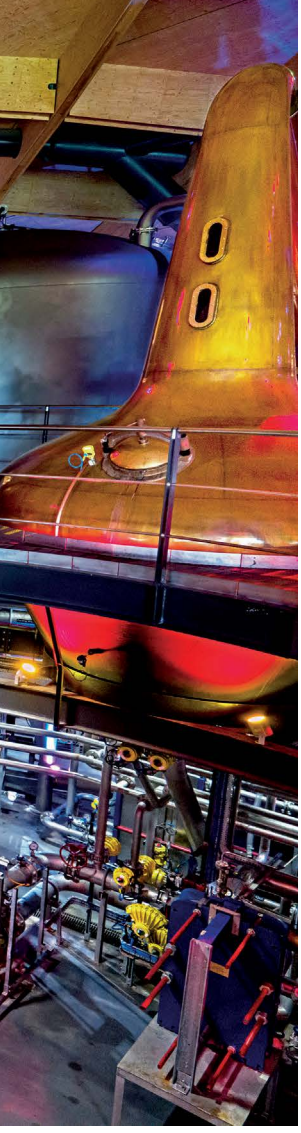




comfortably in a cocktail at a bar, and it can also hold space for a slow, thoughtful dram." While rare expressions such as the 25- or 30-Year-Old reward time and contemplation, Kennedy is refreshingly easygoing. "I'll never tell someone how to drink their whisky," he admits. "What matters is that they explore it."

India: A Palate That Understands Richness

For his first visit to India, Kennedy arrived curious—and left genuinely impressed. What surprised him most wasn't the enthusiasm, but maturity. "The conversations here aren't one-way," he says. "People already understand The Macallan. They've travelled, tasted, compared. They ask informed questions."

India's palate, he observes, naturally leans toward richness—spice, sweetness, texture, and weight. It's a flavour landscape that mirrors The Macallan's sherry-driven profile almost instinctively. From the 12-Year-Old Sherry Oak to the 15 Double Cask, there is a natural resonance with Indian food, culture, and drinking habits; not through forced pairings, but coexistence. Whisky here isn't being dissected. It's being lived with.



Inside the Mind of a Whisky Maker

So how does a whisky maker think? Kennedy laughs because the truth is, that he rarely switches off. Inspiration doesn't strike in isolation. It comes from conversations, cities, shared meals, unexpected moments. Over time, those experiences build what he calls a "flavour library"—an internal understanding of how casks behave, how textures evolve, how stories can be told through liquid. Only then does creativity step in.

Projects like Distil Your World allow The Macallan to translate places— Hong Kong, London, New York— into whisky expressions. Not by imitation, but by interpretation. And India? "That's a story still forming," he adds. "But it's one I'll take back with me."

The conversation concludes with Kennedy describing his role using two words that linger: pressure and privilege. Pressure, to honour generations of whisky makers before him and Privilege to shape what comes next.

In India, that future feels collaborative rather than imposed. The curiosity is already there. The palate is ready. The stories are waiting to be shared—slowly, honestly, and without noise. That's because, if The Macallan teaches us anything, it's this: Great whisky doesn't rush you. It invites you to stay a little longer.